MEDAL FACTORY IS POWERING INDIA'S OLYMPIC DREAMS



Haryana has risen as the undisputed powerhouse of Indian sports, blending grassroots talent, world class infrastructure, and visionary policies

Haryana has emerged as the epicentre of India's sporting revolution — where raw talent, relentless determination and visionary governance converge to produce champions. Though comprising just two percent of the nation's population, the state keeps delivering over half of India's Olympic medals, a testament to its extraordinary athletic culture and robust sports infrastructure.

FROM FIELDS TO PODIUM

The state's dominance on the global stage is remarkable. At the Tokyo Olympics 2020, 32 of India's 126 athletes were from Haryana, winning one gold, one silver, and two bronze medals. Nine Haryanvi women led India's hockey team to a near-podium finish. The state's athletes also excelled in the Tokyo Paralympics, securing six of India's medals.

The momentum only increased. In the 2024 Paris Olympics, Haryana's athletes won five of India's six medals. At the Paralympics that year, they claimed eight of India's 29 medals, reaffirming Haryana's position as the nation's sporting powerhouse.

REWARDING EXCELLENCE

Haryana has put in place a robust ecosystem to support its athletes. Between 2014 and Oct 2025, the state distributed ₹683 crore in cash awards to 16,418 medal winners. Its generous sports policy awards ₹6 crore for Olympic or Paralympic gold, ₹4 crore for silver, and ₹2.5 crore for bronze. Even participants receive ₹15 lakh, along with an additional ₹5 lakh for training and nutrition.

Recognising sport as a viable career, the government created 550 posts in the Department of Sports and Youth Affairs and reserved 10% of Group D and 3% of Group C jobs for athletes in departments such as police, education, and energy.

GRASSROOTS TO GREATNESS

The state's success is built on robust grassroots development. Haryana plans to establish 2,000 sports nurseries, out of which 1,472 are already operational in schools, panchayats, and sports complexes. Each nursery trains 25 athletes under certified coaches, who receive a monthly salary of ₹20,000–₹25,000. Young trainees are awarded monthly scholarships of ₹1,500 (ages 8–14) and ₹2,000 (ages 15–19), ensuring that financial constraints do not hinder emerging talent.

INSTITUTIONS OF EXCELLENCE

At the advanced level, Haryana's Sports University in Rai, Sonipat, has become a leading institution. Its diplomas are now recognised on a par with those from national sports universities such as NIS Patiala. In 2023–24, the state allocated ₹100 crore for upgrading its facilities. The government has also established academies in Panchkula, Ambala, and Karnal, along with 20 district-level centres specialising in wrestling, boxing, athletics, and hockey.

Rehabilitation centres, including one at Panchkula's Tau Devi Lal Sports Complex, provide world-class recovery and physiotherapy facilities valued at ₹10 crore — a rare initiative in Indian sports infrastructure.

Haryana ensures its sporting heroes are honoured. Recipients of the Dhyan Chand, Arjuna, and Dronacharya Awards receive monthly honorarium of ₹20,000. Fifty-two Bhim Awardees were recently recognised with ₹5 lakh each and formal honours totalling ₹2.6 crore.

SPORTING EDGE

- ₹683 crore awarded to 16,418 athletes (2014-2025)
- Haryana hosts India's first dedicated Sports University
- 2,000 sports nurseries planned; 1,472 already operational
- Job reservation for athletes – 10% in Group D, 3% in Group C
- Lifetime honorarium for Bhim, Arjuna, and Dhyan Chand awardees

With academies equipped with cutting-edge infrastructure, generous rewards, and over 1,400 sports nurseries, Haryana fuels over 50% of India's Olympic medals